

Red Sox Finding It's a Hard Luck Season

IT WILL BE something short of a miracle if the Boston Red Sox repeat as American League champions this year. But it's doubtful that any of the fans or writers in Beantown will be demanding the scalp of Manager Dick Williams if this doesn't happen.

No defending champion or serious contender ever has had as many bad setbacks as this club.

CHARLES JOHNSON



★
**Lowdown
on Sports**

Misfortune began when Jim Lonborg was seriously injured in a skiing accident last winter. (Don't club owners tell their expensive stars what they can or can't do during the off season?)

That setback was followed by the loss of Tony Conigliaro for the entire season, and most likely forever, with eye trouble as a result of being disabled by a pitched ball.

But bad luck has trailed the Red Sox all season. They had to send two regulars—Carl Yastrzemski and Elston Howard—home yesterday because of what are termed nuisance injuries. Yastrzemski's injury was diagnosed as a strained wrist ligament.

Jose Santiago, who had been a pleasant surprise as a winning pitcher when lured away from Charles Finley, came up ailing before the All-Star game and has been out of action.

Throw in military calls for some players, short layoffs for Rico Petrocelli, failure of George Scott to hit up to expectations. It all adds up to a good deal more grief than one club should have.

Fight for Existence

NO LOCAL sport has had the struggle for existence as Minneapolis amateur oarsmen.

Saturday they will celebrate another milestone in their hectic history by playing host to the Northwest International Rowing Association's regatta on the new course on the Mississippi River at the foot of the Lake St. Bridge.

Entries from Winnipeg, Fort William, Kenora, Duluth, St. Paul, Milwaukee, Chicago and Kansas State University will participate in this event, one of the highlights of Aquatennial sports program.

It has been touch and go for the Minneapolis club to keep alive financially. It has a boat house on the river on property

furnished by the Minneapolis Park Board. Members built the facilities. They still owe \$100 on their coaching boat, \$390 for lumber and \$700 needed for roofing shingles. They are hoping to eliminate those deficits by contributions from friends of the sport. Their own membership fees take care of maintenance of equipment, electricity and insurance.

Back in 1957, the Minneapolis club stunned the association by finishing first. It has high hopes of doing the same Saturday and Sunday, but just as important is the hope that this regatta will attract plenty of fans to learn how much this activity has added to the river and this new course.

Same Andy Cohen

NOT MANY of the veterans who participated in the Old Timers ball game at the Met Tuesday night could boast that they hadn't changed physical appearances since the days they played for a living.

One exception was Andy Cohen. He finished with the old Millers back in 1939. Now in his 60s, he looked like he could battle almost anyone for a regular position in pro baseball.

Andy, one of the most popular players who ever performed here, never has lost his touch with baseball. A resident of El Paso, Tex. for many years, he coaches for the local league team when it plays at home. He also is coach of the Texas University at El Paso team in the spring.

Never Too Old

THERE AREN'T many veteran baseball players who have done well in this game in the past who lack for a job for any length of time no matter how old he is.

Best example at the moment is Rocky Colavito. He moved from one club to another in the American League in recent years. When the Chicago White Sox dropped him, the Los Angeles Dodgers were willing to gamble on him at a pretty fancy salary.

It appeared to be the end of the line when the Dodgers gave him his walking papers. But the New York Yankees weren't ready to give up on him. They picked him up. In his first game, the slugger rapped out a three-run homer that gave his team a victory. That alone should assure him of a place to play for the rest of the season.

There is such a shortage of major league talent today a veteran has to collapse physically before he can't land a job.